

4.6 Photographing Children

Shooting children is exciting. Unlike adults, children are less aware of the presence of a camera, and are almost always captured in very natural poses. Unfortunately, sitting still is hardly natural for a child, so you should be prepared to move a lot when looking to photograph children. Here are a few basic guidelines to help you get better results and show you what you should or shouldn't do when photographing kids.

Shoot At Eye Level

That's the child's eye-level, not yours. The world looks very different from a child's eyes, and if you shoot from the level that they see everything at, chances are you will end up with interesting results. Sit on the ground and take your photographs—not only



Try and shoot at the child's eye level

does this put you at the right height, it also helps steady your shots. Of course this doesn't mean that you shouldn't be creative and use different perspectives: lying down to make the child seem bigger or perhaps even shooting from high looking down on everything.

Keep the subject comfortable

Some children get a bit nervous when they become conscious of the camera pointing at them. It's up to you to get the camera-shy



TIP

Again, for landscape shots, tilt forward. Enhance the impact of your immediate location in the context of the whole by tilting your camera forward and focusing on what's immediately in front of you while keeping the rest of the landscape in the picture.

Also, shooting from just inside a treeline or through a bunch of tall grass or flowers will heighten the sense of being in the landscape.